

ACADEMY BEYOND THIS WORLD

ENVIRONMENT DNA REFERENCE

Complete Location Guide for Illustrators & Environment Artists

1. Environment Design Philosophy

Every environment in the Academy Beyond This World is a living participant in the story. Spaces are not passive backdrops — they react, remember, and respond to the characters who inhabit them. This document provides complete DNA specifications for every major location.

Every space has purpose. Every structure speaks intent. — ABTW Architecture Doctrine

The three-state system governs all environments: Normal (surface reality), Glitch/Disturbed (perception shifting), and Activated/Restored (hidden system revealed). Artists must be able to render all three states for every location.

1.1 Universal Environment Rules

- Nothing exists for decoration — every element has narrative purpose
- Light is always motivated — every light source must be justified
- Materials age with dignity — wear and use tell stories
- Symbols appear in unexpected places — floor, wall, ceiling, reflection
- Plants and organic elements soften architecture and signal life
- Avoid pure black — use deep navy (#0B132B) or deep purple instead

2. Corridor System

Corridors are the spine of the Academy. They are where the story breathes, where everything begins. The corridor does not change — it reflects what you are ready to see.

2.1 Grand Corridor

Type: Primary ceremonial corridor — spine of the Academy

Architecture: Gothic arched ceilings, golden ornamental details, stained-glass windows

Floor: Intricate marble with glowing circular geometric designs in gold and blue

Lighting: Hanging lanterns (warm amber) + stained glass (warm amber + cool blue)

Signature Elements: Academy banners with star compass symbols, lush green plants, rose window at far end

The Corridor does not change. It reflects what you are ready to see.

State	Visual Character	Atmosphere
Normal	Warm golden light, stable architecture, polished floor reflections, calm	Welcoming, clear, guiding

Glitch	Purple/blue energy, flickering light, symbols briefly appear, distortions	Uncertain, between layers
Activation	Massive glowing compass rose, full geometric patterns, architecture responds	Alive, meaningful, powerful

2.2 Main Academy Corridor

Type: Daily life corridor — heart of student movement

Architecture: Vaulted ceilings with celestial motifs, tall arched windows, wooden study tables

Floor: Polished stone with astronomical diagram at centre

Lighting: Warm ethereal golden light through windows, shimmering floor reflections

Time States: Morning Light / Midday Flow / Quiet Moments / First Glitches / Echoes / After Alignment / Nightfall

The Main Academy Corridor is not just a place. It is the rhythm of learning itself. Treat it with attention — it will guide you further than you know.

2.3 Observation Corridor

Type: Perception training corridor — symbols emerge here first

Key Feature: Reflective floor that shows delays; shadows may hesitate; reflections may lag

Signature Elements: Arched windows, symbolic patterns on walls, observation boards, plants that react to presence

Instruction: Observe first, understand later, act only when the moment is aligned

Six sequential actions for visitors: Look → Wait → Record → Compare → Align → Move On

2.4 Silent Corridor

Type: Deep perception corridor — anomalies appear most clearly here

Visual Character: Translucent glowing blue humanoid figures (memory residues) line both sides

Floor: Dark surface inlaid with glowing golden compass rose and geometric star patterns

Lighting: Steady, non-flickering — stable illumination is a key feature

▮ *Silence is not empty. It is full of what you haven't heard yet.*

Seven-step journey: Enter Silence → Echo Extends → Anomaly Appears → Look Closer → Trace the Pattern → Understand Deeper → Leave with Clarity

2.5 Observation Hallway

Type: Time-perception corridor — where Astra slows, timing shifts

Key Feature: Floating clock-like circular arrays, astrolabe-like instruments, time dilation zones

Central Character: Astra — interacts with luminous circular mandala patterns

Phenomena: Timing Shifts / Rhythm Anomalies / Micro Pauses / Hidden Movement

▮ *Speed shows the surface. Slowness reveals the structure. Awareness connects them.*

2.6 Transition Hallway

Type: Threshold corridor — where perception moves between states

Portal Types: Before/What Was (purple) and After/What Comes Next (golden)

Key Elements: Arched thresholds, perception portals, directional light shifts, floor resonance grids

Seven Stages: The Approach → The Threshold → The Crossing → The In-Between → The Arrival → The Echo → The Next Path

▮ *You are not moving through space. You are moving through meaning.*

2.7 East Corridor — CANONICAL

Connection: Connects classrooms E-01 to Observatory Wing

Normal State: Warm golden sunlight, Gothic hallway, deep blue/gold banners, constellation floor inlays

Disturbed State: Intense violet/purple energy, crackling floor, reality distortion, flickering lights

Recovered State: Cool blue-white clarity, softly glowing symbols, serene

Always-Present Elements: Arched windows, academy banners, constellation floor inlays, wall lamps with spiral energy cores, hidden symbol panels, memory nodes

| *Places remember. Reality responds. What we feel, the world reflects.*

2.8 Corridor Proportion System

All corridors follow consistent proportion rules to maintain architectural coherence:

Corridor Type	Width	Height	Character
Learning	Standard	High	Open, inviting, educational
Transitional	Narrow	Very High	Focused, directional, purposeful
Secret	Very Narrow	Low-Medium	Intimate, hidden, discoverable
Ceremonial	Grand	Monumental	Awe-inspiring, formal, significant

3. Observatory — CANONICAL

Type: Primary knowledge and discovery space

Architecture: Domed ceiling, brass telescopes, marble floors, mechanical and arcane instruments

Six Functional Zones: Main Telescope / Data Consoles / Star Map Table / Library & Archives / Observation Deck / Mechanical Core

Six Symbolic Elements: Spiral (unknown) / Star Compass (guidance) / Orbit Rings (cycles) / Data Grid (knowledge) / Lens/Eye (perception) / Light Beam (discovery)

| *We look up to see more. We look with care to understand. — ABTW*

State	Visual Character	Atmosphere
Daytime	Warm golden steampunk interior, brass telescopes, scholarly energy	Focused, intellectual, warm
Night	Deep blue/purple, holographic star projections, lone figure, contemplative	Mysterious, vast, inspiring
Storm/Anomaly	Purple lightning, flickering instruments, urgent crisis atmosphere	Tense, critical, dramatic

4. Archive / Library — CANONICAL

Tagline: A Sanctuary of Knowledge. Where Memory Becomes Wisdom.

Architecture: Towering bookshelves to vaulted ceilings, Gothic-arched windows, rolling ladders, compass rose floor inlay

Lighting: Warm amber sunlight through tall windows, warm lamp light, candles for stillness, dust motes

Colour Palette Primary: Warm amber, burnt orange, terracotta, muted purple, cream

Colour Palette Accent: Deep navy, teal, violet, forest green, antique gold

Six Archive Zones:

- Reference Wing — history and facts
- Theory Hall — analysis and ideas
- Notebook Archive — personal journeys
- Observatory Access — sky and origins
- Research Tables — active study
- Index Tower — catalogues and maps

Living Details: open books with diagrams, handwritten notes in margins, personal items left behind, bookmarks, coffee cups, stains and wear. Everything has a story.

■ *The more you understand, the more you see how much more there is to learn.*

AVOID: too dark, too cold, too cluttered, too chaotic, too magic-heavy. The library is warm, intelligent, and timeless.

5. Notebook Space — First Pattern

Type: Personal study space — where understanding begins

Setting: Warm study space with large window, golden natural light, fantasy castle view

Key Elements: Natural light, open notebooks with emerging patterns, symbol connections, notes and fragments, quiet focus

Objects: Aged leather-bound books, brass oil lantern, ceramic mug ('Observe, Understand, Connect'), brass compass, sticky notes, pencils, climbing vines

Colour Palette: Rich navy blues, burnished golds, amber lantern light, aged parchment tones

■ *You are not given the answer. You are given the pattern. You learn to read.*

Seven stages of understanding: The First Look → Repeating Marks → Lines Connect → Meaning Emerges → The Pattern → Deeper Reading → It Stays With You

6. Academy Interior Life

6.1 Dormitories

Tagline: Our rooms. Our sanctuary.

Visual DNA: Warm amber lanterns, candles, arched windows, bookshelves, rich blue bedding

Subcategories: Shared Rooms / Personal Corners / Night Atmosphere / Belonging

Lighting States: Daylight (natural, clear) / Evening (warm, gentle) / Night (lamps and stars) / Late Night (magical glow)

Character Room Examples:

- Astra's Room — deep blue, star maps, journals, telescopes (Curiosity & Observation)
- Lumi's Room — soft purple, books, crystals, notes (Wisdom & Imagination)
- Nela's Room — warm gold, plants, sketches (Energy & Adventure)

6.2 Classrooms

Tagline: Where curiosity meets knowledge.

Architecture: Cathedral-like learning hall, soaring arched windows, celestial maps on walls, warm candlelight

Subcategories: Lesson Halls / Specialty Rooms / Circles & Groups / Inspiration

6.3 Lounges & Common Rooms

Tagline: Relax. Share. Be yourself.

Visual Character: Deep blue velvet sofas, crackling fireplace, scattered books, candles, student gatherings

Subcategories: Comfort Spaces / Conversation / Club Corners / Laughter & Joy

7. Academy Grounds & Outdoor Spaces

7.1 Academy Grounds Overview

The Academy Grounds connect, balance, and inspire. They are places of breath, friendship, learning, and quiet magic where life happens between classes.

Location	Character	Purpose
Central Courtyard	Heart of the Academy, open gathering place	Social connection, daily life
Star Garden	Flowers bloom with stars, form living constellations	Wonder, reflection, magic
Reflection Pond	Still waters mirroring sky and soul	Contemplation, memory
Observatory Plaza	Where knowledge meets inspiration	Study, discovery
Light Bridge	Connects towers, minds, and distant places	Transition, connection
Whispering Path	Quiet path through stories and symbols	Reflection, solitude
Memory Garden	Memories planted like seeds	Healing, remembrance
Clock Tower Square	Where time teaches patience and purpose	Rhythm, community

7.2 Academy Gardens System

Tagline: Breathing Places. Living Magic. Growing Memories.

Constellation Flowers: Starlily, Night Orchid, Lumen Rose, Sky Petal, Moonbloom, Wishbell, Galaxy Thistle, Dream Poppy

Symbolic Trees: Memory Tree / Wisdom Oak / Star Weaver / Heartbloom / Timekeeper

Seasonal Transformations: Spring (blossoms, hope) / Summer (vibrant, full) / Autumn (golden, reflective) / Winter (snow, star clarity)

Garden Activities: Read under the trees / Draw constellations / Write in notebook / Talk with friends / Watch the stars / Sit in silence

| In every leaf, a symbol. In every flower, a memory. In every garden, a piece of who we become.

7.3 Outer Forest System

Tagline: The Wild That Remembers. The Silence That Speaks.

Six Forest Regions: Luminwood (bioluminescent, guidance) / Whispering Grove (past whispers) / Starfall Clearing (wishes appear) / Mossheart Paths (ancient memory) / Silent Vale (reflection, healing) / Moonveil Forest (dream boundary)

Forest Magic Rules: Kindness opens paths / Curiosity reveals secrets / Calm brings clarity / Courage shows the way / Respect earns trust

Sacred Trees: Wisdom Tree / Memory Tree / Protector Oak / Star Blossom / Dreaming Willow

| *The forest does not hide its magic from you. It shows you only what you are ready to see.*

7.4 Outer World

Five Locations: Forests / Parks / Lake / Pathways / Nearby Town

Lake: Still waters reflecting crescent moon, weeping willows, solitary figure on dock — waters that reflect the sky and the soul

Nearby Town: Lantern-lit village, warm shop windows, 'Constellation Exchange' establishment, kind people with stories

Spirit: This world is alive. It changes with the seasons, with the stars, and with you.

8. Emotional Spaces System

Some places don't change the world. They change you. These are the spaces that hold feelings, the corners that remember, the places that become part of who you are.

Space	Visual DNA	Emotional Purpose
Rooftops	Open sky, star view, gentle wind, warm lights, quiet feeling	Clarity, deep talks, dreaming big
Hidden Corners	Natural cover, soft light, intimate, safe, overgrown nooks	Safety, quiet thoughts, sanctuary
Memory Gardens	Flowers, reflection water, light orbs, glowing central tree	Healing, remembrance, letting go
Notebook Spots	Books, paper, sketches, warm light, inspiration	Ideas, discovery, understanding

| *The world is big, but these places are yours.*

9. Floor Motif & Bridge Systems

9.1 Floor Motif System

Canon Rule: The floor is not decoration — it is architecture of meaning

Symbol Geometry Evolution: Point → Circle → Intersection → Star → Polygon → Lattice → Mandala

Application Spaces: Academy Hall / Observatory / Ritual Chamber / Library / Garden Atrium

| *THE FLOOR SPEAKS WHAT WORDS CANNOT.*

9.2 Bridge Resonance System

Canon Rule: A bridge is a promise between patterns. A crossing is an agreement between souls.

Seven Resonance Phases: Dormant → Awakening → Alignment → Harmonisation → Threshold Open → Transit → Integration

Bridge Components: Anchor Spires / Resonance Conduits / Pattern Lattice / Threshold Gate / Harmonic Core / Resonance Rails

Five Crossing Conditions: Intent / Alignment / Balance / Permission / Readiness

Five Threshold Types: Academic / Elemental / Astral / Historic / Living Bridges

10. Environment Quick Reference

Location	Primary Palette	Key Light	Signature Element
Grand Corridor	Navy, gold, amber	Stained glass + lanterns	Compass rose floor inlay
Main Corridor	Warm gold, stone	Window light	Astronomical floor diagram
Observation Corridor	Purple, blue, gold	Soft ambient	Reflective floor with delays
Silent Corridor	Deep navy, white-blue	Steady, non-flickering	Glowing memory residues
Observatory	Brass, deep blue, gold	Directional + holographic	Main telescope dome
Library	Amber, terracotta, navy	Warm lamp + window	Compass rose floor inlay
Gardens	Deep green, purple, gold	Soft magical glow	Constellation flowers
Outer Forest	Deep green, blue, lavender	Bioluminescent	Sacred trees
Dormitories	Navy, purple, amber	Lantern + starlight	Arched windows
Rooftops	Deep blue, gold, open sky	Moonlight + lanterns	Star view

Every space has purpose. Every structure speaks intent. Every journey transforms.